

1942 Allied forces seize control of Algeria from the French Vichy administration. Algeria becomes a base for the Free French movement.

1947 An Algerian national assembly is established, although restrictive voting qualifications mean that few Muslims have the vote.

1954 The first of a series of guerrilla attacks marks the start of independence struggle led by the National Liberation Front (Front de Libération Nationale, FLN). French forces numbering 450,000 are deployed in an attempt to retain control of the country.

1958 French Algerian generals, fearing that the French government will negotiate with the FLN, stage a coup. As a result Charles de Gaulle returns to power. After a referendum in metropolitan France and its colonies, including Algeria, where Muslim women are allowed to vote for the first time, the Fifth French Republic is established with de Gaulle as president. Meanwhile, the FLN sets up a “free Algerian” government in Cairo with Ferhat Abbas as prime minister.

1959 In the face of continued heavy fighting, de Gaulle proposes a referendum on independence for Algeria. French colonists and military personnel opposed to Algerian independence set up the Organization of the Secret Army (Organisation de l’armée secrète, OAS).

1961 The French government and the Algerian provisional government agree to begin negotiations on independence. An OAS-led coup in Algeria collapses after four days.

1962 Negotiations result in the signing of a formal ceasefire agreement in Evian, France, and in agreements on the holding of a referendum on independence. The French people approve these agreements in a referendum in 1963.

1962 In a referendum, 91.2 percent of total registered electorate votes in favor of independence, which is declared on July 3. Ahmed Ben Bella is elected prime minister and, after the approval by referendum of a constitution, he is elected first president of Algeria.

1965 Military junta topples the government of Ahmed Ben Bella. Revolutionary council set up.

1966 Judiciary is “Algerianized.” Tribunals try “economic crimes.”

1971 Oil industry is nationalized. President Boumedienne continues with land reform, a national health service, and “socialist” management.

1976 National Charter establishes a socialist state.

1980 Ben Bella is released after 15 years’ detention. France gives incentives for the return home of 800,000 Algerian immigrants.

1987 Limited economic liberalization. A cooperation agreement is signed with the USSR.

1988 Amid anti-FLN violence, a state of emergency is declared.

1989 Constitutional reforms diminish the power of the FLN: new political parties are founded, including the Islamic Salvation Front (FIS).

1990 Political exiles are permitted to return. FIS wins municipal elections.

1991 FIS leaders Abassi Madani and Ali Belhadj arrested. The FIS wins most seats in elections to the National People’s Assembly.

1992 Second round of elections is canceled. President Chadli is overthrown by the military. President Boudiaf is

assassinated. Madani and Belhadj are given 12 years in jail.

1993 Political violence led by extreme rebel Armed Islamic group (GIA).

1995 Democratic presidential elections are won by Liamine Zéroual.

1996 Murders continue, notably of Catholic clergy and a GIA leader.

1997 Madani is released from jail but debarred from active politics.

1999 Abdelaziz Bouteflika elected president in poll boycotted by opposition.

2000 FIS voluntarily disarms.

2001 Hundreds die in Berber protests.

2002 Berber language Tamazight is recognized as a national, although not an official, language.

2004 President Bouteflika is reelected.

2005 Charter for Peace and Reconciliation is approved in a referendum.

2006 A six-month amnesty is offered to Islamic militants.

2007 33 people killed in bus blasts in Algiers.

2009 President Bouteflika wins a third presidential term.

«158–59 Diffusion of Knowledge
«174–75 The Ascent of Islam
«412–13 End of the Colonial Era

Tunisia



North Africa’s smallest country has been a province of several ancient empires.

c.1100 BCE Phoenician traders establish a port at Utica and gain control of the coastal region from the Berbers.

814 BCE Carthage founded by Phoenician Queen Elyssa (Dido). By the sixth century BCE Carthage has a population of 400,000 and controls the coastal trading ports from Leptis (in modern Libya) to Lixus and Mogador in Morocco.

264 BCE First Punic War marks the start of three Roman wars against Carthage, culminating in the sacking of Carthage in 146 BCE and Roman occupation.

439 CE Vandal tribes capture Carthage, ending Roman occupation.

534 Byzantine rule is reestablished.

698 Arab invaders seize Carthage and establish a new city at Tunis.

1230 The Hafsids dynasty is founded. Tunis becomes the capital.

1574 Tunisia becomes a province of the Ottoman Empire.

1883 La Marsa Treaty makes Tunisia a French protectorate.

1920 Destour (Constitution) Party calls for self-government.

1935 Habib Bourguiba forms Neo-Destour (New Constitution) Party.

1943 Defeat of Axis powers by British and American troops restores French rule.

1955 Internal autonomy. Bourguiba returns from exile.

1956 Independence. Bourguiba elected prime minister. Personal Statutes Code gives rights to women.

1957 The Bey is deposed. Tunisia made a republic with Bourguiba as president.

1964 Neo-Destour made sole legal party; renamed Destour Socialist Party (PSD).

1969 Agricultural collectivization, begun 1964, is abandoned.

1974 Bourguiba is elected president-for-life by National Assembly.

1974–76 Hundreds imprisoned for belonging to “illegal organizations.”

1978 Trade union movement, UGTT, holds 24-hour general strike.

1983–94 Palestine Liberation Organization has headquarters in Tunis.

1987 Fundamentalist leader Rachid Ghannouchi is arrested. Ben Ali takes over the presidency after doctors certify Bourguiba senile. PSD renamed the Constitutional Democratic Rally (RCD).

1988 Most political prisoners released. Reforms introduce multi-party system.

1991 Abortive coup is blamed on fundamentalist party al-Nahda, which is banned.

1996 Opposition leader Mohammed Moad of the Movement of Social Democrats (MDA) is imprisoned.

1999 Ben Ali and the RCD again dominate elections.

2006 Government campaigns against the wearing of headscarves by women.

2007 Islamist militants clash with security forces in Tunis.

2009 President Ben Ali wins a fifth term.

2011 Ben Ali is forced to stand down after massive street protests and flees to Saudi Arabia.

«158–59 Diffusion of Knowledge
«174–75 The Ascent of Islam
«200–01 The Crusades
«246–47 The Ottoman Empire



The Barbary pirates

Pirates operating out of ports on the Barbary coast terrorized the Mediterranean for centuries. The French tried to suppress them with battleships in 1688 (above), but it was not until 1815 that the threat was lifted.